

Delaware County Council Meeting April 23rd 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wmXJscjXbjU
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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: April 2023 (Exact calendar day not explicitly stated in the transcript, though referenced as the April 2023 meeting; next meeting set for May 28, 2023)

Body: Delaware County Council

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer at [00:06:40](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Langan, Mr. Hughes, Mr. M (or Moko/Mel), Mr. Webb, Mr. Wad (or Wyad), Mr. K (or Gance) Piper, and Freeman. (*Note: Transcript captures various spellings/phonetic representations during roll call, reflecting a full council*).
 - **Absent/Noted:** Presiding officer/President (unnamed explicitly by title other than presiding over the meeting) and various department heads/officials presenting items.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Mary [00:06:45](#).

- **Approval of Agenda & Minutes:**

- The agenda was approved with two proposed amendments: adding the February 27th public hearing minutes and updating the next meeting date to May 28th 00:07:39 (Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call 7-0).
- Prior meeting minutes (February 16th council meeting, February 27th public hearing, and March 26th council meeting) were removed from the table and approved 00:08:22<U+2013>00:09:52.

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

Memorial Resolution

- 00:09:52 **Memorial Resolution for Martha Jane Lasser**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** State Senator Scott Alexander, joined by Melanie 00:10:09.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Senator Alexander presented Indiana General Assembly State Concurrent Resolution No. 15, memorializing Martha Jane Lasser. Lasser served Delaware County for over 40 years across multiple roles (Township Trustee, Treasurer, Auditor, Recorder, and 9 years as a County Councilwoman) and lived by the motto "people before politics." Copies of the resolution were presented to the council and family.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Presented as a ceremonial resolution (No formal vote required/recorded).

Financial Transfers & Appropriations

- 00:14:00 **Courts Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Covers various line-item adjustments including probation officer pay correction (\$152.31), courtroom maintenance (\$12,400 for moving jury monitors and ClearOne zoom equipment to improve visibility and accessibility), and office equipment (\$8,972 for replacement copers). Councilmembers debated the ongoing costs of building design flaws at the Justice Center and whether alternative temporary fixes (like carts or ladders) should be used instead of spending thousands.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved (Roll call vote: 6 Yes, 1 No [Mr. Webb]) 00:27:44.
- 00:28:08 **Jail Transfers (Sergeants, Corporals, Deputies)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson / Jail administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Backfilling and position reallocations (Sergeants, Corporals, and Deputies) resulting in a net transfer of zero.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) [00:30:25](#).
- **00:30:49 Jail Transfers (Correctional Officers & Merit Deputies)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson / Jail administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Backfilling correctional officer and merit deputy positions. Administration noted the jail is successfully training part-time staff to handle vacancies and reduce overtime.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved (Roll call vote passed) [00:32:37](#).
- **00:33:02 Communications (911) Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred (911 Director).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Moving funds to cover communication technician lines, holiday pay, and overtime. Director Fred discussed minimum staffing requirements, the impact of recent emergencies (tornado, eclipse), call volume increases, and projected annual overtime shortfalls.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved (Roll call vote passed) [00:41:34](#).
- **00:41:50 Assessor Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Assessor department representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Backfilling a personal associate position (net transfer zero).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved (Roll call vote passed) [00:42:13](#).
- **00:42:28 Sheriff & Jail Additional Transfers (Other LIT / Addendums)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff / Court administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Routine backfilling for deputies, correctional officers, and assistant court reporters.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved (Roll call vote passed across multiple items) [00:42:55](#)<U+2013>[00:45:09](#).
- **00:45:30 Highway Department Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway department representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Backfilling a truck driver position (net transfer zero).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved (Roll call vote passed) [00:45:55](#).
- **00:46:13 Auditor Additional Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ed Carroll, Auditor [00:46:32](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$7,000 in contractual services to configure existing financial software to properly track capital assets and encumbrances digitally, eliminating manual spreadsheets and streamlining state audits.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved (Roll call vote passed) [00:50:42](#).
- **00:51:01 Delco Fair and Expo Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Donna / Fair administration [00:51:37](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** \$35,000 total (\$33,000 for repairs/maintenance and \$2,000 for equipment) utilizing Ball Brothers grant funds for batteries and maintenance on deflators.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved (Roll call vote passed) [00:51:41](#).
 - [00:51:57](#) **Misdemeanant Fund Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail / Sheriff administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** \$50,000 from the misdemeanor fund for contractual medical/inmate costs and medicines at the jail. Council thanked the sheriff for utilizing discretionary funds to subsidize inmate care.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved (Roll call vote passed) [00:53:42](#).
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Ordinances & Resolutions (First Reading / Introduction)

- [00:42:25](#) **Ordinance 2024-X (Salary Ordinance Amendment / Backfilling Process)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President / Finance Committee / Fred.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Repeals and replaces portions of the salary ordinance to eliminate the rigid "A, B, C" line-item tracking system historically used when backfilling positions. The change ties line items to the *position* rather than the specific *individual*, streamlining the backfilling process for department heads while maintaining strict safeguards to keep line items in the black. Monthly summary reports will be provided to the council.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved for Introduction (Roll call vote passed) [01:07:41](#). Will return in May for final passage.
 - [01:13:25](#) **Ordinance 2024-9: Mobile Home Permit Fee Ordinance**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad (Treasurer's Office) [01:13:36](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Establishes a \$15 mobile home title transfer/permit fee to offset administrative costs and curb repetitive, speculative title flipping by out-of-state corporate mobile home park owners. Councilmembers debated whether the fee would inadvertently burden low-income residents purchasing mobile homes.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved for Introduction (Roll call vote passed) [01:13:59](#).
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- No members of the public signed up or spoke during the general public comment period [01:35:15](#).
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Fred (911 Director):** Notified council of an upcoming \$63,000+ purchase for a recorder upgrade and radio console. Because of publication deadlines, he

presented the item publicly for consensus before formal appropriation in May
[01:30:59](#).

- **Tony Skinner (Sheriff):** Notified council that the Sunset Clause for the Deferred Retirement Option Plan (DROP) program expires in June and will be brought forward next month to be made permanent [01:33:04](#).
- **Council President:** Reminded citizens that the primary election is May 7th, with early voting ongoing and Saturday voting hours available [01:35:32](#). Provided a brief update on the county salary study progress with Kent Irwin [01:36:51](#).
- **Adjournment:**
 - **Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call [01:37:38](#).
 - **Next Meeting:** Tuesday, May 28, 2023, at 9:00 AM [01:37:46](#).

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